

COLD STORAGE

Draft 1 - branching sequence

INT. THE PANCAKE SHACK - NIGHT

NORA slides into the booth across from **ELI**, out on the north side of town past the old gas station - the same cracked vinyl seat, the same buzzing neon sign flickering red through the window behind him, same as always.

ELI

You said this was the last favor.

NORA

It is. After tonight, we're square.

Eli doesn't answer right away. Outside, gulls are already circling the water a few blocks off - the old cannery, probably, picking through whatever the tide left behind.

Does Nora go to the old cannery to finish this herself, or does she send Eli instead and stay behind? Going herself leads into Cannery Run. Sending Eli leads into Waiting It Out.

CANNERY RUN

EXT. WATERFRONT - LATER

Nora picks her way along the old cannery's loading doors, half of them rusted shut, gulls scattering off the pilings as she passes. Whatever's inside, she's not walking away from it clean.

The sequence ends here for tonight - what's behind those doors is next episode's problem.

WAITING IT OUT

INT. MIDNIGHT DINER - LATER

Nora's back in a booth an hour later, two blocks off the harbor now instead of the north side of town - same cracked vinyl under her, same neon sign still buzzing outside the window, waiting on a text from Eli that hasn't come yet.

The sequence ends here for tonight - whatever Eli finds out there is next episode's problem too.